

# MTGNP

Magic: The Gathering Multiplayer Network Protocol v1.0

MTGNP is a two-player, server-authoritative implementation of the Magic: The Gathering Multiplayer Network Protocol v1.0 for CSNETWK. The required base protocol and gameplay milestones are implemented. Optional full-card-effect coverage is now in progress; graphical interfaces remain later optional work.

## Base milestone status

| Area                    | Status           | Evidence                                                                                                   |
|-------------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Protocol and framing    | Complete         | All 25 PDU types, four-byte big-endian frames, 65,535-byte limit, sender validation                        |
| Lobby and setup         | Complete         | Two seats, deck validation, hidden hands, random first player, London mulligan                             |
| Turn engine             | Complete         | Every phase/step, Draw Step, priority, Cleanup, restart                                                    |
| Mana, spells, and Stack | Complete         | Land limits, inferred mana payment, LIFO resolution, state-based actions, more than five effects           |
| Combat                  | Complete         | Attackers, blockers, order, first strike, simultaneous damage, summoning sickness                          |
| Resilience              | Complete         | PING/PONG, priority deadlines, concession, 30-second reconnect grace, repeat games                         |
| Submission package      | Locally complete | README/PDF, diagrams, AI disclosure, test matrix; LAN and cross-group checks require external participants |

The automated suite currently contains 120 tests and uses only Python's standard library at runtime.

## Optional milestone status

| Milestone                         | Status   | Result                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| O1A. Simple spell families        | Complete | Declarative spell rules plus Shock, Lava Spike, Flame Slash, Searing Spear, Cancel, and Negate |
| O1B. Zones and resources          | Next     | Naturalize, Terror, Raise Dead, Rampant Growth, Dark Ritual, and Incinerate                    |
| O1C-O1F. Full catalog closure     | Planned  | Choices, special costs, permanent effects, then a 58-card coverage audit                       |
| O2-O4. Creative features and demo | Planned  | UI polish, one spectator/replay or GUI extension, and bonus demonstration hardening            |

The detailed order, card grouping, and acceptance gates are in docs/OPTIONAL\_MILESTONES.md.

## Requirements

- Python 3.11 or newer
- Two terminal windows for clients and one for the server
- TCP port 4444 reachable between the machines for a LAN game
- No third-party runtime packages

## Build and test

Open PowerShell in the MTGNP directory:

### Command / example

```
$env:PYTHONPATH = "src"
python -m unittest discover -s tests -v
```

An editable install is optional:

### Command / example

```
python -m pip install -e .
```

After an editable install, `mtgnp-server` and `mtgnp-client` may be used in place of `python -m mtgnp.server` and `python -m mtgnp.client`.

## Regenerate the submission PDF

The game has no third-party runtime dependency. Rebuilding the documentation PDF additionally requires ReportLab:

### Command / example

```
python -m pip install reportlab
python scripts/build_readme_pdf.py
```

The stable output path is `output/pdf/README.pdf`. Regenerate it after filling in the Work Distribution Matrix or changing the README.

## Run a local game

Open three PowerShell terminals in this directory and set the source path in each terminal:

### Command / example

```
$env:PYTHONPATH = "src"
```

Start the authoritative server:

### Command / example

```
python -m mtgnp.server --verbose
```

Start player 1:

### Command / example

```
python -m mtgnp.client --player-id alice --deck decks/stack_demo_red_green.json --auto-keep --verbose
```

Start player 2:

### Command / example

```
python -m mtgnp.client --player-id bob --deck decks/stack_demo_blue_black.json --auto-keep --verbose
```

`--verbose` is the required demo mode. It prints every complete PDU sent and received with direction, peer, type, sequence number, timestamp, and formatted JSON. Remove the flag for normal play. Add `--auto-pass` to both clients for an unattended protocol smoke test.

For a LAN game, run the server on one computer, allow inbound TCP port 4444 in the host firewall, determine the host's LAN IPv4 address, and give both clients that address:

### Command / example

```
python -m mtgnp.client --host 192.168.1.10 --player-id alice --deck decks/stack_demo_red_green.json --auto-keep --verbose
```

## Terminal controls

At a priority prompt the client accepts:

### Command / example

```
pass
concede
land CARD_ID
cast CARD_ID [TARGET ...]
activate SOURCE_ID ABILITY_INDEX [TARGET ...]
```

Examples:

## Command / example

```
land mountain_001
cast lightning_bolt_001 bob
cast counterspell_001 stk_0001
cast doom_blade_001 goblin_guide_001
activate prodigal_sorcerer_001 0 bob
activate millstone_001 0 bob
```

Mana payment is inferred from the catalog and paid by atomically tapping legal sources. Diagnostic overrides are available:

## Command / example

```
cast doom_blade_001 goblin_guide_001 --mana B=1,X=1
activate millstone_001 0 bob --mana X=2
```

Combat prompts accept attacker IDs separated by spaces, none, and blocker pairs such as `phantasmal_bear_001=goblin_guide_001`. The attacker is prompted for damage order when several creatures block one attacker.

## Rules behavior that may not be obvious

- The first player skips only the Draw Step of turn 1. The second player draws on turn 2, and the first player begins drawing on turn 3.
- Playing a land is not casting a spell and does not require mana. Only the active player may play one land during either of that player's Main Phases.
- Receiving priority during the opponent's turn permits responses such as Instants, but it does not make the responding player the active player.
- Lands remain tapped until their controller's next Untap Step. The terminal's Available mana line counts currently untapped mana sources.
- Both players must pass consecutively to resolve the top Stack item or advance an empty priority window.

## Disconnect and reconnect

An unexpected in-game connection loss pauses the authoritative game and reserves that seat for 30 seconds. The server cancels the outstanding priority deadline while paused.

To reconnect, rerun the same client command before the grace period ends. The `PLAYER_READY` PDU acts as the reconnect handshake and must contain the exact same player ID and ordered deck list. The server then:

- 1 verifies the reserved identity and deck;
- 2 sends fresh personalized authoritative state;
- 3 issues a fresh priority, combat, trigger, mulligan, or discard token; and
- 4 continues the original game without reshuffling or resetting it.

A changed identity or deck is rejected and the reservation remains active. If the timer expires, the connected opponent receives `GAME_OVER` with reason `DISCONNECT`. The grace duration can be configured for demonstrations:

## Command / example

```
python -m mtgnp.server --reconnect-grace 30 --verbose
```

## Architecture

### Diagram source

```
flowchart LR
    C1["Terminal client: player 1"] <-->| "Framed JSON over TCP" | S["Authoritative MTGNP server"]
    C2["Terminal client: player 2"] <-->| "Framed JSON over TCP" | S
    S --> P["Protocol validation and tracing"]
    S --> L["Two-seat lobby and lifecycle"]
    S --> G["Game, Stack, abilities, triggers, combat"]
    G --> D["Fixed CSV card catalog"]
```

The clients send intent only. They never determine whether an action succeeds or calculate a winner. Every accepted mutation occurs in the server game engine, and each GAME\_STATE\_UPDATE replaces the client's local view.

The game lifecycle is:

### Diagram source

```
flowchart LR
    L["LOBBY"] --> S["GAME_SETUP"]
    S --> M["MULLIGAN"]
    M --> G["IN_GAME"]
    G --> O["GAME_OVER"]
    O --> L
    G -- "connection lost" --> R["RECONNECT GRACE"]
    R -- "same player and deck" --> G
    R -- "30 seconds expires" --> O
```

## Implemented effects

The base rubric requires at least five effects. The implementation exceeds that gate with spell effects, activated abilities, and triggered abilities.

- Spells: Lightning Bolt, Shock, Lava Spike, Flame Slash, Searing Spear, Unsummon, Counterspell, Cancel, Negate, Giant Growth, Doom Blade
- Activated abilities: Prodigal Sorcerer, Royal Assassin, Millstone, Rod of Ruin
- Triggered abilities: Goblin Guide, Monastery Swiftspear, Phantasmal Bear, Gray Merchant of Asphodel, Gravedigger

Dedicated demonstrations are available in decks/ability\_demo\_\*.json and decks/trigger\_demo\_\*.json. Optional milestone O1A can be played with decks/optional\_spells\_red.json and decks/optional\_spells\_blue.json.

## Test coverage

Automated tests cover catalog reconciliation, all PDU shapes, malformed and fragmented framing, hidden information, mulligans, turn transitions, draws, land and mana rules, Stack ordering and countering, state-based actions, combat, activated and triggered abilities, timeouts, heartbeat behavior, concession, same-connection restart, reconnect success, reconnect rejection, and reconnect expiry.

The external checks in docs/INTEROPERABILITY\_TEST\_MATRIX.md must be completed on the actual demo machines. They are deliberately not marked as passed in advance.

## Known limitations and RFC interpretations

- MTGNP defines reconnect as required but defines no reconnect/session PDU. This implementation reuses PLAYER\_READY with the same player ID and exact ordered deck. This is an implementation-defined extension using an existing PDU rather than adding a non-standard message type.
- Player IDs are not authenticated because MTGNP 1.0 defines no authentication. The reconnect check prevents accidental seat takeover, not a malicious peer that already knows the original player ID and deck.
- A legal deck may contain fewer than seven cards. Setup draws all cards that are available; a later required draw from an empty library loses the game.
- Each physical card instance ID may occur in only one submitted deck.
- Each physical server-to-client PDU receives a distinct monotonically increasing server sequence number, including separate broadcast copies. The explicit Section 11 exception reissues the current token unchanged after a rejected action while that player still holds priority.
- Eleven spell effects and selected activated/triggered abilities are supported. Full behavior for every catalog card is optional bonus work and is being added through the O1 milestone sequence.
- The required client is terminal-based. A graphical interface is optional.

## Work Distribution Matrix

Replace the member headings and every Record actual contribution cell before submission. Do not claim work that a member did not perform.

| Task / Feature                             | Member 1                   | Member 2                   | Member 3                   | Member 4                   |
|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------|
| TCP server, connections, framing, dispatch | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution |
| Lobby, setup, and mulligan                 | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution |
| Turn and phase engine                      | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution |
| Priority, Stack, spells, and abilities     | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution |
| Combat system                              | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution |
| Client and state rendering                 | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution |
| All 25 PDU types                           | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution |
| Errors, heartbeat, timeout, and reconnect  | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution |
| Verbose PDU tracing                        | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution |
| Tests and interoperability                 | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution |
| README, diagrams, and disclosure           | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution | Record actual contribution |

## AI Usage

OpenAI Codex was used as a learning and development assistant to analyze the provided MTGNP specification and CSV catalog, propose milestone boundaries, explain MTG rules and protocol behavior, draft and revise Python implementation code, create automated tests, improve terminal readability, diagnose gameplay issues, and prepare documentation. Its output was applied to the local project through an iterative workflow and checked with the automated test suite.

Before submission, every group member must personally review the implementation, run the tests, perform the manual interoperability checks, and be able to explain the generated or assisted code. Update this disclosure if any other AI tool is used.

## Project documentation

- docs/FOUNDATION\_DECISIONS.md - catalog and RFC interpretation decisions
- docs/TRANSPORT\_DESIGN.md - TCP framing, connection wrapper, and tracing
- docs/LOBBY\_DESIGN.md - lobby and ready validation
- docs/GAME\_SETUP\_DESIGN.md - setup, hidden state, and mulligans
- docs/TURN\_ENGINE\_DESIGN.md - turns, priority, draws, and cleanup
- docs/STACK\_AND\_SPELLS\_DESIGN.md - lands, mana, spells, Stack, and effects
- docs/COMBAT\_DESIGN.md - combat validation and damage
- docs/ACTIVATED\_ABILITIES\_DESIGN.md - activated-ability registry and flow
- docs/TRIGGERED\_ABILITIES\_DESIGN.md - triggers, choices, and APNAP ordering
- docs/OPTIONAL\_MILESTONES.md - ordered bonus roadmap and full-card-effect slices
- docs/RESILIENCE\_DESIGN.md - timeout, heartbeat, concession, and reconnect
- docs/ARCHITECTURE\_AND\_DEMO.md - component and sequence walkthrough
- docs/INTEROPERABILITY\_TEST\_MATRIX.md - required external test record
- docs/SUBMISSION\_CHECKLIST.md - final packaging and demo checklist